

Aurelia Grand Hotel Group

# Housekeeping SOP and Room Quality Manual

Room release, inspection, cleaning standards, defect reporting, and quality audit procedures

|                |                                                            |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
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| Applies To     | Housekeeping, front office, maintenance, and quality teams |
| Approved By    | VP Rooms Division                                          |

**Purpose and usage**

This controlled document defines operational standards for hotel teams. It is intended to support consistent decisions, clear accountability, accurate record keeping, and high-quality service recovery across Aurelia properties. Teams must apply local legal requirements when those requirements are stricter than this standard.

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## 1. Room Release Principles and Department Responsibilities

A guestroom may be released only when it meets Aurelia cleanliness, safety, maintenance, and presentation standards. Housekeeping, front office, and maintenance share responsibility for accurate room status. A room marked clean but not actually ready creates service risk and may lead to guest recovery costs.

| Role                    | Responsibility                                                                               | Required record                          |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Room attendant          | Clean assigned rooms according to zone checklist and report defects.                         | Room completion time and defect notes.   |
| Housekeeping supervisor | Inspect required sample of rooms and all high-risk rooms.                                    | Inspection status and corrective action. |
| Front office            | Assign rooms only after system status is clean/inspected according to property standard.     | Room assignment timestamp.               |
| Maintenance             | Resolve or classify defects before room release when defects affect guest comfort or safety. | Work order status.                       |
| Executive housekeeper   | Review trends, failed inspections, training needs, and repeat room issues.                   | Weekly quality report.                   |

### High-risk room release

- Early check-in rooms with turnaround under 30 minutes.
- Rooms previously occupied by families, groups, pets, or long-stay guests.

- Rooms with prior maintenance tickets in the past 14 days.
- Rooms assigned to VIP, accessibility, or high-value bookings.
- Rooms that failed inspection earlier the same day.

## 2. Standard Cleaning Sequence

The cleaning sequence is designed to reduce missed areas and create consistent presentation. Team members should not skip steps during high occupancy periods. When a room cannot be completed to standard before arrival, the supervisor must notify front office rather than mark the room ready.

1. Enter safely, inspect for damage, lost property, odors, pests, and maintenance defects.
2. Remove trash, used linen, glassware, food items, and guest consumables.
3. Clean bathroom fixtures, shower, toilet, sink, mirror, floor, ventilation grille, and amenities tray.
4. Replace linen, inspect mattress protection, arrange pillows, and check headboard and bedside surfaces.
5. Dust furniture, lighting, remote control, desk, wardrobe, safe, minibar area, and window ledges.
6. Vacuum or mop floors, inspect corners, skirting boards, and under furniture where reachable.
7. Restock amenities according to room type and guest profile notes.
8. Set temperature, lighting, curtains, TV position, and final presentation standard.
9. Report maintenance defects and block room if comfort or safety is compromised.
10. Complete room status update only after final self-check.

### Minimum timing standard

Rooms should not be released based only on elapsed time. However, a full departure clean completed in under 12 minutes is considered a quality risk and should trigger supervisor review unless the room was minimally used and the supervisor records the exception.

## 3. Bathroom Quality Standards

Bathroom presentation strongly affects guest trust. Hygiene failures are treated more seriously than cosmetic defects because they affect comfort, confidence, and perceived safety.

| Area                  | Required standard                                                                               | Failure examples                                  |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Toilet                | Clean bowl, seat, base, flush plate, and surrounding floor; no stains, hair, odor, or residue.  | Hair on seat, visible stain, odor, unclean base.  |
| Shower/bath           | Clean glass, tiles, drain, fixtures, and seals; no soap residue, mold, hair, or standing water. | Hair in drain, soap scum, mold mark, wet floor.   |
| Sink and counter      | Dry, polished, free of toothpaste, hair, dust, and product residue.                             | Spots on mirror, residue around tap, water rings. |
| Towels and amenities  | Correct count, clean condition, folded to standard, no stains or damage.                        | Missing towels, stained towel, unsealed amenity.  |
| Floor and ventilation | Floor clean and dry; grille visibly free of heavy dust.                                         | Sticky floor, dust buildup, poor odor.            |

### Bathroom failure classification

A bathroom with visible hair, used amenities, unclean toilet, strong odor, or mold-like staining should not be considered ready. If discovered after guest arrival, the case normally requires supervisor inspection and a room move or immediate reclean offer.

## 4. Bedroom, Linen, and Furnishing Standards

| Element                     | Standard                                                                             | Notes                                             |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Bed linen                   | Fresh, smooth, correctly sized, no stains, tears, hair, or odors.                    | Any doubt requires replacement.                   |
| Pillows and duvet           | Correct count and presentation; protection checked according to cycle.               | VIP and family profiles may require extras.       |
| Furniture                   | Clean surfaces, no sticky residue, no visible damage that affects use.               | Damage must be photographed and logged.           |
| Lighting and controls       | All lamps and switches working unless maintenance ticket permits controlled release. | Non-working bedside light affects comfort.        |
| Remote and high-touch items | Sanitized and positioned according to room layout.                                   | Remote, phone, handles, safe keypad.              |
| Window and curtains         | Clean visible glass, functional curtains or blinds, no major dust.                   | Privacy defects require attention before release. |

### Lost property and guest items

Found items must be bagged, labeled, and recorded immediately. Staff may not keep, discard, or move items without logging them. Food or hazardous items should follow local property disposal rules and supervisor review.

## 5. Inspection and Room Status Controls

Inspection standards create accountability between room cleaning and room assignment. The property may adjust inspection percentage by occupancy, staffing, and quality performance, but high-risk rooms must always receive supervisor attention.

| Inspection type       | When required                                               | Record needed                             |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Self-check            | Every room before status update.                            | Room attendant completion timestamp.      |
| Supervisor inspection | VIP arrivals, high-risk rooms, failed rooms, random sample. | Pass/fail status and notes.               |
| Executive inspection  | Repeat complaint rooms, quality audit, training sample.     | Detailed checklist and corrective action. |
| Joint inspection      | Major maintenance or cleanliness dispute.                   | Housekeeping and maintenance notes.       |

### Status rules

- Dirty: room not started or not ready.
- Clean: room cleaned but not inspected where inspection is required.

- Inspected: room released for assignment.
- Out of order: room cannot be sold due to safety, comfort, or operational defect.
- Out of service: minor defect exists but room may be used with manager approval and guest disclosure if applicable.

A room with unresolved AC, plumbing, lock, electrical, pest, or hygiene issue should not be released as inspected without manager approval.

## 6. Defect Reporting and Interdepartmental Handoff

Housekeeping must report maintenance defects immediately when discovered. Defects affecting room comfort or safety must be visible to front office before room assignment. A verbal handoff alone is not sufficient for repeat issues.

| Defect category            | Examples                                                           | Required action                                                  |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Comfort                    | AC not cooling, heating issue, noisy fan, TV not working.          | Create maintenance ticket; hold room if unresolved and material. |
| Safety/security            | Door lock fault, exposed wiring, broken glass, unstable furniture. | Block room and notify duty manager.                              |
| Plumbing                   | Leak, blocked toilet, no hot water, slow drain.                    | Maintenance ticket; block if immediate guest impact.             |
| Cleanliness infrastructure | Mold-like staining, persistent odor, pest evidence.                | Supervisor inspection and room block pending resolution.         |
| Cosmetic                   | Small scuff, minor paint chip, low-impact furniture mark.          | Log for planned maintenance if room can be used.                 |

### Handoff notes

Handoff notes should include room number, time found, staff name, observed condition, guest impact, photo if available, and whether the room is blocked. Avoid vague phrases such as “needs attention” without describing the issue.

## 7. Complaint Review and Evidence Preservation

When a guest reports a cleanliness concern, the first priority is to correct the room or move the guest. Evidence should be preserved to understand what happened, not to challenge the guest unnecessarily.

- Request a supervisor inspection when the guest is still in-house and willing to allow room access.
- Preserve staff notes, cleaning timestamps, inspection status, and any photos provided by guest or supervisor.
- Do not delete or overwrite room notes after a complaint is received.
- Compare check-in time, room release time, and cleaning completion time for timing risk.
- If the room was turned quickly, record whether supervisor inspection occurred.

### Photo handling

Photos should be reviewed for room match, visible issue, timing, and relevance. A photo does not need perfect metadata to be useful if the issue clearly matches the room and other records support the complaint.

## 8. Training, Audit, and Corrective Action

Quality improvement depends on visible coaching and trend review. Repeated failures should be treated as process signals, not only individual errors.

| Metric                                     | Review frequency              | Owner                                    |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Failed room inspections                    | Daily during shift briefings. | Executive housekeeper                    |
| Guest cleanliness complaints               | Weekly.                       | Quality manager and housekeeping leader  |
| Fast-turnover rooms under timing threshold | Weekly.                       | Rooms division manager                   |
| Repeat defects by room                     | Weekly with maintenance.      | Executive housekeeper and chief engineer |
| Training completion                        | Monthly.                      | Department trainer                       |

### Corrective actions

11. Immediate reclean or room move when guest impact exists.
12. Supervisor coaching with documented checklist review.
13. Process review for rushed turnover, staffing pressure, or inspection gap.
14. Joint housekeeping-maintenance review for repeat room defects.
15. Follow-up audit within 7 days for repeated issue categories.

## 9. Special Room Types and Guest Profiles

Some rooms require additional care because the setup is more complex or the guest impact of failure is higher. These rooms should be identified during the morning briefing and again before room release.

| Room/profile type | Additional requirement                                                                          |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Accessible room   | Confirm bathroom aids, bed layout, door clearance, emergency features, and requested equipment. |
| Family room       | Check sofa bed, crib, child amenities, additional towels, and waste removal.                    |
| Pet-friendly room | Deep-clean according to pet protocol; inspect odor, hair, and floor condition.                  |
| Connecting rooms  | Confirm both rooms, connecting door function, and key setup.                                    |
| Suite or VIP room | Supervisor inspection required; amenities, minibar, and defects checked before release.         |

A special request that cannot be fulfilled should be communicated to front office before guest arrival. Front office must not discover the issue only when the guest reaches the room.

## 10. Linen, Laundry, and Amenity Controls

Linen and amenity failures often appear minor but can affect guest confidence in cleanliness. Any stained, torn, strongly scented, damp, or suspicious linen must be removed from circulation.

| Control point           | Standard                                                                                |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Clean linen storage     | Covered, dry, separated from soiled items, and protected from food or chemical contact. |
| Towel quality           | No stains, fraying, strong odor, or visible discoloration.                              |
| Amenity setup           | Correct quantity by occupancy and room type; sealed where applicable.                   |
| Laundry issue reporting | Repeated stains or odor reported to laundry vendor or internal laundry supervisor.      |
| Emergency shortage      | Notify rooms division manager before reducing standard guest setup.                     |

Shortages must not be concealed by leaving incomplete setups. If the property cannot meet the standard, the deficiency must be communicated and corrected as soon as possible.

## 11. Shift Briefing and End-of-Day Quality Controls

| Briefing item      | Morning shift                                         | Evening shift                                   |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| VIP arrivals       | Identify rooms requiring inspection.                  | Confirm rooms released and any amenity issues.  |
| Early arrivals     | Prioritize realistic rooms; avoid rushed release.     | Review complaints from early arrivals.          |
| Out-of-order rooms | Confirm status and blockers.                          | Verify no blocked room was assigned by mistake. |
| Repeat defects     | Review rooms with maintenance history.                | Confirm engineering follow-up.                  |
| Staffing risk      | Adjust inspection percentage and supervisor coverage. | Record any rooms released under pressure.       |

The executive housekeeper or delegate should review failed inspection reasons daily. Repeated failures in the same zone or same room attendant route require coaching and, when needed, process change.

## 12. Detailed Zone Checklist - Guestroom

The zone checklist is used for training, supervisor inspection, and quality audits. It is not intended to slow experienced attendants during normal operations; it defines the visible standard that every released room must meet.

| Zone                  | Inspection points                                                                                     |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Entry and wardrobe    | Door surfaces, lock, peephole, wardrobe floor, hangers, iron, safe, luggage rack, lighting, odor.     |
| Sleeping area         | Linen, pillows, headboard, bedside tables, lamps, phone, clock, outlets, floor under bed edge.        |
| Work and seating area | Desk surface, chair, trash bin, minibar or refreshment area, glassware, menu, remote, visible cables. |
| Window area           | Curtains or blinds, window ledge, privacy, glass marks, balcony door where applicable.                |

|                    |                                                                                        |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bathroom dry zone  | Mirror, sink, counter, amenities, towels, tissue, bin, floor, visible hair or residue. |
| Bathroom wet zone  | Shower screen, bath, fixtures, drain, grout, sealant, water marks, soap residue.       |
| Final presentation | Temperature, lights, curtains, scent, collateral placement, room door closure.         |

Any failure in bathroom hygiene, linen condition, lock function, major odor, or temperature comfort must be corrected before room release or escalated for manager decision.

### 13. Deep Clean, Preventive Quality, and Room Recovery

Deep cleaning is scheduled to protect long-term room quality and reduce complaints that are not resolved by normal daily cleaning. The schedule must reflect occupancy, seasonality, room type, and complaint trends.

| Deep-clean area          | Minimum focus                                                             |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bathroom grout and seals | Mold-like staining, mineral marks, drain condition, shower glass buildup. |
| Soft furnishings         | Odor, stains, upholstery marks, cushion condition, curtain dust.          |
| Floor edges and corners  | Dust buildup, carpet marks, under-furniture debris.                       |
| High-touch controls      | Remote, switches, thermostat, phone, safe keypad, handles.                |
| Air quality              | Vent grilles, filter coordination with maintenance, odor source review.   |

#### Room recovery after maintenance

After maintenance work, housekeeping must check dust, footprints, water marks, odors, displaced furniture, and amenity reset before the room returns to inspected status. Engineering completion alone does not make the room guest-ready.

### 14. Quality Audit Scoring and Corrective Training

Quality audits should be scored consistently. Scores are used to identify training needs and process gaps, not to punish staff for isolated errors. Serious hygiene failures require immediate correction regardless of total score.

| Score band       | Interpretation                          | Required action                                              |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 95-100           | Aurelia standard met.                   | Recognize performance and continue normal sampling.          |
| 85-94            | Minor presentation or consistency gaps. | Supervisor coaching and follow-up spot check.                |
| 70-84            | Multiple misses or one material miss.   | Documented coaching and repeat inspection within seven days. |
| Below 70         | Room should not have been released.     | Manager review, retraining, and process audit.               |
| Critical failure | Hygiene, safety, privacy, or major      | Immediate correction and                                     |



|  |                  |                         |
|--|------------------|-------------------------|
|  | comfort concern. | department-head review. |
|--|------------------|-------------------------|

When a complaint is linked to a failed room release, the audit should review staffing level, arrival pressure, supervisor coverage, maintenance status, and whether the room was assigned before inspection was complete.